Emily Hals

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Operational architect, people leader, and business builder. Specialized in closing the gap between the current state and what's possible by developing people, systems, and process for high-growth businesses.

> Sitting at the intersection of people and process, I design and implement organizational structure that creates thriving teams, stable foundations, and sustainable growth.



OPERATIONS + PEOPLE LEADER • ORGANIZATIONAL ALIGNMENT • STRATEGIC ADVISOR

Hi Spawn team,

Here's my character sheet. Career operator, advisor to founders, and the person leaders hand the messy stuff to. My highest stat is judgment: knowing what deserves attention, what can wait, what gets delegated, and what gets a polite no.

That's the job you described. Your agents run the machinery. You need someone above it who knows when the defaults are wrong.

What I'd bring to the party:

- ~10 years as the filter between several fast-moving founder/CEOs and everyone who wanted their time, protecting their focus and improving their decision making, without allowing them to become the bottleneck that slows the business down.
- A builder from scratch. I create the process, structure, and teams a business needs where none exist yet.
- Calm in chaos. As VP of Launch Operations at NOBULL, I kept launches moving across factories in Asia, teams in the U.S., and partners like the CrossFit Games and NFL Combine while revenue grew from $36M to $250M.

I'd love to be your founder's judgment layer.

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EXPERIENCE

2024 – Present

eighty8 vision

Founder · Business Builder · Strategic Advisor · Operations Architect

- Conduct organizational audits and assessments to identify misalignment, risks, and growth barriers across people, processes, and systems, and translate findings into actionable plans.
- Partner directly with business owners and leadership teams to build aligned, human-centered organizations, tailoring solutions to each client's goals, structure, and stage of growth.
- Design job descriptions, role definitions, and organizational charts that clarify responsibilities, decision rights, and reporting relationships.
- Build leadership succession plans and stage-appropriate structure that reduce an owner's day-to-day dependency and prepare the business for its next stage.
- Build change management roadmaps and advise owners and leaders through growth, restructuring, high-stakes decisions, communication strategies, and cultural shifts.
- Lead strategic planning and goal setting to define business objectives and determine priorities to align leadership teams, cross-functional teams, or the entire organization.
- Identify current and future talent and capability gaps, and define role and reporting relationships in line with business needs and goals.
- Design operational infrastructure, including workflows, systems, and processes, to optimize day-to-day efficiency and enable sustainable scaling.
- Human Resources hub for organizations without dedicated support. Building and evaluating retention strategies, career development paths, onboarding/offboarding, policies, and performance markers.
- Guide first-time founders in outlining the roles, systems, and structures needed for day-one operations and planning for scaling.

2025 – Present

FOCLE

Organizational Alignment Leader · Project Based Consultant

- Partner with an HR + Operations consulting firm to lead organizational alignment projects for small and mid-sized organizations experiencing deeper misalignment, such as deferred planning, stalled decision-making, or significant change or growth.
- Diagnose and evaluate organizational structure, roles and responsibilities, decision rights, reporting relationships, processes, and systems to identify where strategy, structure, people, and operations are misaligned.
- Translate diagnostic findings into phased realignment plans and guide implementation, including organizational redesign, role definition, and process and systems improvements aligned to growth or contraction models.

2024 – 2025

Minnesota Ice

Head of Operations and Business Development

- Led operational remediation and business realignment, including an in-depth audit of business, talent, and processes.
- Defined business goals and performance metrics.
- Developed a strategic, detailed plan to close the gap between current state and goals.
- Designed and implemented streamlined workflows and process documentation across all departments: Sales, Marketing, Engineering, Logistics, Production, and Design.
- Developed and implemented employee policies and compensation alignment strategies.
- Standardized job descriptions, onboarding, and performance review processes to ensure team alignment and performance.

Ranked #1,416 · Inc 5000 (2024) | Ranked #7 · Fast 50 (2023)

2024

GymReapers

Vice President of Product Operations · Project Based

- Led short-term strategic projects focused on operational realignment and growth readiness.
- Optimized product design, development, and supply chain efficiency by implementing process and structure.
- Created the operational strategy for demand planning, aligning production with sales targets and market trends.
- Transitioned portions of an unstable supply chain to stable partners while at the height of growth and demand.
- Implemented timeline tracking and launch calendars to bring alignment across the organization.
- Partnered with customer service and warehouse to identify significant quality issues and build out escalation procedures.

Ranked #302 · Inc 5000 (2024)

2018 – 2023

NOBULL

Vice President of Launch Operations *(VP of Development + Production)*

- Led Product Development, Production, Supply Chain + Launch Operations departments to align product delivery with business goals, driving $36M to $250M revenue growth in four years.
- Scaled a department of direct reports spanning Footwear, Apparel & Accessories Development, Sourcing, Production Planning, Quality Assurance, and Events & Partnerships from 5 to 50+ employees across the U.S. and Asia.
- Led the team and organization through change management and organizational redesign across two acquisitions.
- Led company-wide change management for the Centric PLM implementation and NetSuite ERP remediation.
- Developed and onboarded the organization into more efficient cross-functional communication processes.
- Developed team members from entry level into Director and Senior Director roles.
- Fostered a high-retention, high-trust culture, achieving the highest employee satisfaction scores in company census results.
- Led end-to-end product development, manufacturing, and supply chain operations for 5,000+ SKUs.
- Managed the global supply chain team, overseeing 15 to 20 primary assembly factories and 30 to 50 supporting factories.
- Rebuilt the apparel supply chain to keep pace with rapid growth, adding overseas capacity while preserving quick-turn local production.
- Developed and implemented scalable operational practices, reducing inefficiencies and improving production timelines.
- Oversaw full-cycle product development, from concept to commercialization, ensuring quality, cost, and delivery objectives were met.
- Spearheaded product lifecycle management from design to final distribution, ensuring seamless execution across DTC, retail, and major event partnerships (CrossFit Games, NFL Combine, PGA Tour).

- Led operational strategy for demand planning, aligning production with sales targets and market trends, and established contingency plans and risk mitigation strategies to ensure supply chain stability and business continuity.
- Led onsite athlete uniform and retail production.
- Developed and implemented employee training and onboarding programs for the product operations department.

2013 - 2018

Kraus-Anderson Construction

Project Manager · Commercial General Contractor

- Project managed commercial construction projects ranging from $50K to $200MM.
- High level of internal cross-functional team and external vendor coordination required to align project objectives with execution.
- Functioned as a liaison between project management teams, field teams, architects, building owners, subcontractors, and engineers, refining problem solving, communication, and leadership skills.
- Led the pilot implementation of Lean Construction principles in over $100MM in new-build projects, maximizing efficiency and driving successful outcomes.
- Selected by ownership to be a member of the Construction Project Team for Kraus-Anderson's $200M downtown mixed-use development, including their $30M new corporate headquarters.
- Recognized by senior management and team members for problem-solving skills and sound decision-making in high-pressure environments.

2011 - 2013

TCM Construction *Closed 2020*

Project Coordinator & Business Administration · Commercial and Residential General Contractor

- Maintained daily business operations, including budgets, accounts payable/receivable, labor allocations, and resource management to ensure financial success.
- Supported the oversight of commercial and residential construction project execution from planning to completion.
- Managed administrative functions, contract negotiations, and cost control.
- Coordinated project bidding, vendor relations, city permits, and owner communications.
- Partnered with the owner to build operational structure and a succession plan, including a future retirement timeline and first vacation in 5 years.
- Handled marketing efforts, customer service, and cross-trained in various operational areas due to the small office size.
- Developed a comprehensive understanding of Construction Project Management and small business operations.